

Sai Suresh Macharla Vasu

Master's Student, Saarland University

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

AI safety and evaluation; personalized and memory-augmented AI; human–AI interaction; interdisciplinary approaches to AI safety

EDUCATION

Saarland University, Saarbrücken, Germany

Oct 2023 – Present

Master of Science in Data Science and Artificial Intelligence

Current Grade: 1.6

Anna University, Chennai, India

Aug 2017 – Aug 2021

Bachelor of Engineering in Computer Science and Engineering

Final Grade: 8.92 CGPA ($\approx$ 1.8 GPA on the German grading scale)

RESEARCH/ACADEMIC EXPERIENCE

SPAR (Supervised Program for Alignment Research)

Research Fellow – Fall 2026

Sep 2026 – Present

- Working on **Moral Shadowbanning**, studying whether conversational AI provides systematically different levels of helpfulness, honesty, or harmlessness to users perceived as having poor moral character.

CISPA Helmholtz Center for Information Security, St. Ingbert, Germany

Student Research Assistant – Trustworthy ML Group

Dec 2025 – Present

- Conducting research on **LLM reviewer bias**, studying how author identity, affiliation, and writing style influence LLM assisted peer-review outcomes.
- Ongoing Master's thesis on **long-horizon personalization via Personal Knowledge Graphs**, focusing on user memory, temporal updates, and adaptive conversational AI.

AI Safety Saarland Research Group, Saarbrücken, Germany

Research Fellow – AI Safety Saarland Incubator

Oct 2025 – Feb 2026

- Worked as a research fellow with Dr. Indira Sen on social biases in multimodal LLMs.

Saarland University, Saarbrücken, Germany

Teaching Assistant – ML Courses

Nov 2024 – Feb 2026

- Elements of Machine Learning (WS 24/25, WS 25/26)
- Machine Learning (SS 25)

Deutsches Forschungszentrum für Künstliche Intelligenz (DFKI), Saarbrücken, Germany

Student Research Assistant – Interactive Machine Learning Group

Jul 2024 – Nov 2025

- **AuditCopilot: Fraud Detection with LLMs** — interpretable tax anomaly detection surpassing traditional audit tests.

PUBLICATIONS

Justice in Judgment: Unveiling (Hidden) Bias in LLM-assisted Peer Reviews

Sai Suresh Macharla Vasu*, Ivaxi Sheth*, Hui-Po Wang, Ruta Binkyte, Mario Fritz

Findings of ACL 2026

<https://aclanthology.org/2026.findings-acl.14/>

Safe for Whom? Rethinking How We Evaluate the Safety of LLMs for Real Users

Manon Kempermann, Sai Suresh Macharla Vasu, Mahalakshmi Raveenthiran, Theo Farrell, Ingmar Weber

International Association for Safe & Ethical AI (IASEAI 2026)

<https://ojs.aaai.org/index.php/IASEAI/article/view/43033>

AuditCopilot: Leveraging LLMs for Fraud Detection in Double-Entry Bookkeeping

Md Abdul Kadir, Sai Suresh Macharla Vasu, Sidharth S. Nair, Daniel Sonntag

NeurIPS 2025 Workshop on Generative AI in Finance

<https://arxiv.org/abs/2512.02726>

ACADEMIC SERVICE & LEADERSHIP

Reviewer, NeurIPS 2026

2026

Evaluations & Datasets Track; AI4GOOD Workshop; PALM Workshop.

Co-organizer, AI Safety Saarland – Advanced Fellowship

Summer Semester 2026

Supported the organization of an advanced AI Safety Saarland fellowship, including coordination, session planning, and hosting reading groups and invited talks.

Student Volunteer, ACL 2026

San Diego, USA

Association for Computational Linguistics

July 2026

Selected as a student volunteer and received a complimentary conference registration waiver worth USD 800.

AWARDS

Saarland Scholarship for International Students

Saarbrücken, Germany

StudienStiftungSaar & Saarland Ministry of Finance and Science SS 2025 (€1,000) · SS 2026 (€1,200)

Awarded for outstanding academic performance during the M.Sc. in Data Science and Artificial Intelligence at Saarland University.

President Scout Award, Indian Scouts and Guides (Pfadfinder)

New Delhi, India

Indian Scouts and Guides; presented by former President of India Dr. Pranab Mukherjee Dec 2016

National-level scouting distinction recognizing leadership, community service, discipline, and citizenship.